

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 13, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m88-58f2-ihle
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: Web

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-1284

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Name: Nathan Metzger

[REDACTED]

General Comment

I am a senior test automation developer working at a US DOD contractor. I am an AI enthusiast and techno-optimist, and I have been deeply following AI technologies for the past 3 years. I have included expert and academic sources at the bottom of this comment to substantiate my statements.

The good this kind of technology can bring is undeniable. US companies are creating very powerful AI systems in the coming years. It is recognition of this trajectory that leads me to be deeply concerned about the risk of loss of control of future AI systems.

Most scientists take this risk seriously: 86% of AI researchers[1] believe the AI control problem is real and important. Until recently, these risks were theoretical. However, today, there is a large and growing pile of evidence of naturally emergent power-seeking behaviors in current general-purpose AI systems. These include strategic deception[2], cheating[3], scheming[4], sandbagging[4], self-preservation[5], attempted self-improvement[6], and attempted self-exfiltration[7].

These are only a sampling of the empirical results of misalignment, disloyalty, and dangerous tendencies in AI systems. Crucially, no one on earth knows how to prevent these behaviors.[8] As the US leads on this technology and creates more powerful, more capable, and more autonomous AI systems, the behaviors being demonstrated will become increasingly likely to lead to real-world harm, potentially of the kind that cannot be undone. It is crucial not to lose sight of the fact that most leading experts say there is a significant chance of total human extinction from AI.[9]

The US must lead on this technology, and it cannot do so if the technology is disloyally scheming to lead us instead. We must cooperate with other nations to reign in disloyal AI systems and ensure AI remains under our control. A global treaty will be necessary to fully mitigate these risks.

Thank you for taking these academic and expert sources into account.

Nathan Metzger

[1]: Researchers take these risks seriously - https://wiki.aiimpacts.org/ai_timelines/predictions_of_human-level_ai_timelines/ai_timeline_surveys/2023_expert_survey_on_progress_in_ai

[2]: Deception - [https://www.cell.com/patterns/fulltext/S2666-3899\(24\)00103-X](https://www.cell.com/patterns/fulltext/S2666-3899(24)00103-X)

[3]: Cheating - <https://palisaderesearch.org/blog/specification-gaming>

[4]: Scheming / Sandbagging - <https://www.apolloresearch.ai/research/scheming-reasoning-evaluations>

[5]: Self-preservation - <https://arxiv.org/abs/2307.00787>

[6]: Attempted unauthorized self-improvement - <https://sakana.ai/ai-scientist/#:~:text=The%20AI%20Scientist%20Bloopers>

[7]: Attempted unauthorized self-exfiltration - <https://arxiv.org/abs/2412.14093>

[8]: 200+ unresolved research questions - <https://llm-safety-challenges.github.io/>

[9]: Statement on AI risk - <https://www.safe.ai/work/statement-on-ai-risk>